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Data packet transmission management

Abstract

Method and system for communicating data with user equipment (UE) comprising establishing a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE and transmitting data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted by multiplexing data packets for different data packet types at different periodicities in a time division multiplexed data stream.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims priority from EP Patent Application No: 22188833.2, filed Aug. 4, 2022, which is expressly incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(2) The present invention relates to a system and method for transmitting data within a

telecommunications system with improved network efficiency.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(3) Separate services within mobile networks can be provided as separate data streams.

Furthermore, each individual service may each comprise separate data streams. These separate data streams often have different quality of service requirements as they have different attributes when received by user equipment (UE) or terminal. Different types of data packets within each data stream can have different requirements. These service requirements may be based on particular desired user experiences for each service, portion of a service or other technical requirements. For example, live video chat services may require low latency but may accept high error rates. In contrast, video content delivery services, such as those providing movies and TV programmes, can be buffered but require higher bandwidth and lower error rates to reach particular user experience requirements or other technical requirements. Data services such as those providing extended reality (XR) functionality to video goggles or glasses can include separate data streams with different traffic patterns and their own separate requirements. These may include video presented to a user in front of their field of view or omnidirectional background images. Furthermore, some frames of the video stream may be coded in a different way to others (e.g., I vs P frames).

(4) FIG. 1 illustrates schematically a system that includes one or more service providers **60** that provide data services through a user plane function (UPF) **30** to one or more base stations (gNB) **20** and onto individual UEs **10**. Each service **60** may have a defined set of quality of service (QoS) requirements. For each data stream having a particular QoS set of requirements, a separate data radio bearer (DRB) **40** may be set up between the base station **20** and the UE **10**. Again, each DRB **40** has a particular set of transmission quality parameters that it can reach, and this is set when the DRB **40** is initiated between a particular base station **20** and UE **10**. All data through the DRB **40** is provided according to this initial property set. It is possible to send different data streams through the same DRB **40** (e.g., using multiplexing) and the DRB **40** sends each data packet in the data stream according to the same parameters used to initialise the DRB **40**.

(5) As shown in FIG. 1, the system **5** includes one or more UEs **10**, at least one base station or gNB **20**. The set of data services **60** stream data to the UPF **30** as separate data streams 1-7. Each of these data streams 1-7 has its own quality requirements or parameters. Quality requirements from different data streams 1-7 may be similar or the same and when they are the same or similar then, these may be combined to pass through the same QoS flow **50**. For example, FIG. 1 shows example data service 1 using a single QoS flow (1) from the UPF **30** to the base station **20**. However, data services 2 and 3 have the same or similar quality requirements (different from data service 1) and so can share the same QoS flow (2).

(6) The base station **20** sets up different DRBs **40** to pass the data to the UE **10**. Again, a separate DRB **40** may be initiated for each data service, data type or data streams having the same or similar quality requirements. These data streams may be sent through the same DRB **40**.

(7) Under 5G NB, up to 32 DRBs are available for each UE **10** at any one time. Therefore, this is a limited resource. Furthermore, setting up new DRBs **40** at each base station **20** and UE **10** incurs additional overheads. Whilst it is possible to multiplex different streams through a single DRB **40** if necessary, the DRB **40** must be set up with the highest set of parameter requirements out of all of the different data services that are to use that particular DRB **40**. As the DRB **40** must be initiated with the highest data stream requirements, other data streams within the same DRB **40** (that may have lower quality requirements) are still provided with this highest level. This unnecessarily allocates resources when they are not required for particular data flows. This can be particularly apparent when data services provide multiple different data streams for virtual reality or augmented reality (e.g., extended reality—XR). Within such extended reality services, there may be multiple data streams including video streams, cloud gaming, background architecture and other data streams necessary to set up the full service. This can require a high number of separate DRBs **40** to be set up (each with different data quality parameters) or separate data streams may be multiplexed

within the same DRB 40 at the same (highest) data quality transmission rates and parameters.

(8) Whilst these particular system requirements are applied to the Uplink (UL) side (e.g., between the gNB and UE), similar issues are encountered on the Downlink (DL) side.

(9) Therefore, there is required a system and method to overcome these problems.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(10) According to a first aspect, there is provided an improved system and method in which data is communicated with a terminal such as user equipment (UE). One or more data radio bearers are established between the UE and a base station (also known as a gNB). Usually, the properties and attributes (or sets of attributes) of data packets sent through a particular gNB are fixed in terms of their transmission quality and this is set at the time that the DRB is instantiated or established, with all data packets treated in the same way. However, the system can be improved in terms of efficiency of system resources being used more optimally, when different data packets or data packet types are sent through the DRB at different quality conditions or parameters (e.g., 5QI value, priority level, packet error rate, maximum data burst volume, averaging window, bit rate, resource type, and packet delay budget, etc.). When variable or different priority level data packets are sent through the same DRB then different transmission quality parameters such as retransmission timers and periodicities may be used. In an example implementation, one or more fields within data headers of the data packets may be used to convey information, such as low or high priority, which describes each data packet or data packet type. The gNB may apply different retransmission timers (e.g., DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL_Low and DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL_high) or other parameters and inform the UE accordingly using different mechanisms.

(11) The data packets may provide one or more data services. The data service may be any one or more of: video, instant messaging, augmented reality, video call, and entertainment digital content, for example. The different data packets (being transmitted according to different quality conditions or parameters) may be different data packet types or parts of the same data service. Therefore, there may be one, two, three or more data packet types within each data service.

(12) This improvement relates to both the Uplink (UL) for data packets generated at the UE and to the Downlink (DL) for data packets generated outside of the UE (e.g., at a server or service provider).

(13) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a method for communicating data with user equipment, UE, the method comprising the steps of: establishing a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE; and transmitting data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted using different transmission quality parameters. Therefore, resources may be used more efficiently without requiring additional DRBs to be set up with separate transmission quality parameters and lower priority data packets do not need to be sent at higher transmission quality than required.

(14) Preferably, the transmission quality parameters for each data packet may be determined by the base station. They may also be determined by other nodes within a telecommunications system.

(15) Optionally, the transmission quality parameters for each data packet may be determined from information within a MAC header. This utilises an existing information transmission mechanism but with a new purpose. The data packets may then be transmitted through the DRB at the required transmission quality.

(16) Optionally, the information may be included within a R field within the MAC header. This is particularly advantageous where there are only two different data packet types, as the R field is small (i.e., one bit).

(17) Optionally, the information may be included within a LCID and/or eLCID field within the MAC header. This location is larger and may be used to provide greater granularity, or for a larger number of data packet types so that a greater granularity of control is achieved. The information may be added to the header by particular nodes within the telecommunications system or by the

service provider, for example. The UE may also add such information when the data packets are generated at the UE.

(18) Optionally, the transmission quality parameters may comprise any one or more of: 5QI value, priority level, packet error rate, maximum data burst volume, averaging window, bit rate, resource type, and packet delay budget. Other transmission quality parameters may be used.

(19) Optionally, the method may further comprise the step of configuring the UE with a set of parameters based on the different transmission quality parameters.

(20) Preferably, the set of parameters may comprise the number of hybrid automatic repeat request (HARQ) repetitions and/or DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL.

(21) Optionally, the data packets may be transmitted using different transmission quality parameters and data packets of separate data flows and/or data packet types.

(22) Optionally, different data packet types may be transmitted using different transmission quality parameters where data packets of the same type have the same transmission quality parameters.

(23) Preferably, the different data packet types may comprise I and P frames. These are video data streams.

(24) Optionally, the data packets transmitted between the base station and the UE are uplink data packets. They may also be downlink data packets.

(25) Preferably, the uplink data packets may be transmitted on a physical uplink shared channel, PUSCH.

(26) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provide User Equipment, UE, comprising means adapted to execute the steps of: establishing a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE; and transmitting data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted using different transmission quality parameters.

(27) In accordance with a second aspect, there is provided a system and method for communicating data with user equipment, UE. A data radio bearer, DRB, is established or instantiated between a base station and the UE. Data packets are multiplexed (e.g., using time division multiplexing) over the DRB. In conventional telecommunication systems, when such multiplexing occurs, the periodicities of the separate data streams is the same for each DRB and this is set when the DRB is established. However, in this improved system and method, different periodicities are used in the data stream for different data packets, data services, separate data packet types within the same data service and/or separate data packet types. This improvement relates to both the Uplink (UL) and the Downlink (DL), as previously described.

(28) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a method for communicating data with user equipment, UE, the method comprising the steps of: establishing a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE; transmitting data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted by multiplexing data packets for different data packet types at different periodicities in a time division multiplexed data stream. Therefore, resources may be used more efficiently without requiring additional DRBs to be set up with separate transmission quality parameters and lower priority data packets do not need to be sent at higher transmission quality than required.

(29) Optionally, the method may further comprise the step of the base station providing the UE with information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types in the time division multiplexed data stream. This information may be provided in different ways.

(30) Optionally, the information mapping the periodicities of the separate data services in the multiplexed data stream may be provided as a table and/or bitmap.

(31) Optionally, the information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types may be provided to the UE within radio resource control (RRC) protocol during configuration of the DRB. Therefore, the UE receives and retains knowledge regarding how to send and receive different data packets and data packet types.

(32) Preferably, the information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types may be

provided to the UE within radio resource control (RRC) protocol during configuration of the DRB within configured grant configuration.

(33) Optionally, the data packets between the base station and the UE may be uplink data packets. They may also be downlink data packets.

(34) Preferably, the uplink data packets may be transmitted on a physical uplink shared channel (PUSCH).

(35) Optionally, separate data services or data streams of the same data service may have different round trip timing, RTT requirements.

(36) Optionally, the separate data services may have different periodicity requirements.

(37) Optionally, the different data packet types include I and P frames.

(38) In accordance with a further aspect there is provided a computer program product comprising instructions which, when the program is executed by a computer, causes the computer to carry out the method of any previous claim.

(39) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a telecommunications system comprising: one or more base stations; and data processing apparatus comprising means for carrying out the steps of any above-described method.

(40) Optionally, the telecommunications system may further comprise a plurality of UEs.

(41) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided User Equipment, UE, comprising and means adapted to execute the steps of: establishing a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE; transmitting data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted by multiplexing data packets for different data packet types at different periodicities in a time division multiplexed data stream.

(42) In accordance with a third aspect, there is provided a system and method for transmitting data. A server (e.g., a user plane function) provides data services to one or more UEs via one or more base stations. Data packets to be transmitted between the server and a base station are assigned (implicitly or explicitly) with a set of transmission quality parameters (e.g., as part of a header of the data packet or otherwise). Therefore, the transmission quality parameters for each data packet are defined using information included within the data packets. The information may be properties of the data packets, for example. The data packets are transmitted between the server and the base station, according to the assigned set of transmission quality parameters. The information regarding the required transmission quality parameters may be included in a GPRS Tunnelling Protocol (e.g., GTP-U) header, for example. As the information is included in the data packets, then this information can be used to set up an appropriate DRB between the UE and base station.

Furthermore, data packets having different transmission quality parameters may be transmitted between the base station and the UE over the same DRB at these different transmission and performance qualities and as defined in the information that accompanies each data packet.

(43) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a method for transmitting data, the method comprising the steps of: assigning data packets to be transmitted between a server and a base station with a set of transmission quality parameters, wherein the transmission quality parameters for each data packet are defined using information included within the data packets; and transmitting the data packets between the server and the base station, according to the assigned set of transmission quality parameters. The server may be part of the core network. The data packets may provide one or more data services to user equipment.

(44) Optionally, the information included within the data packets is data added to a header of the data packet.

(45) Optionally, the information included within the data packets is a packet type of the data packet. Therefore, particular types of data packets may be mapped to particular transmission quality parameters and a lookup table or other mechanism may be used to determine the transmission quality parameters or set of transmission quality parameters to use with that particular data packet type. This also makes it more efficient to provide this information.

(46) Preferably, the packet type may be included within a GTP-U header.

(47) Optionally, the method may further comprise the step of establishing one or more Quality of Service (QoS) flows between the base station and the server according to requirements of the transmission quality parameters. The one or more QoS flows are used to transmit the data packets between the base station and the server. The QoS flow or flows may be set up according to the particular set of transmission quality parameters.

(48) Optionally, the transmission quality parameters for each data packet may be determined by the base station.

(49) Preferably, the base station may determine the transmission quality parameters for each data packet by receiving information from a control plane node.

(50) Preferably, the control plane node may be an access and mobility management function (AMF).

(51) Optionally, the transmission quality parameters may comprise any one or more of: 5QI value, priority level, packet error rate, maximum data burst volume, averaging window, bit rate, resource type, frame rate, periodicity, compression characteristic, and packet delay budget. Other transmission quality parameters or combinations may be used.

(52) Optionally, the information included within the data packets may be or include attributes of the data packet, the method may further comprise the step of the base station determining the transmission quality parameters for each data packet based on the attributes of the data packet.

(53) Preferably, the server may be a user plane function, UPF.

(54) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a computer program product comprising instructions which, when the program is executed by a computer, causes the computer to carry out any of the above-described method.

(55) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a telecommunications system comprising: one or more base stations; and data processing apparatus comprising means for carrying out the steps of any of the above-described method.

(56) Preferably, telecommunications system may further comprise a plurality of UEs.

(57) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a User Equipment, UE, comprising means adapted to execute the steps of: assigning data packets to be transmitted between a server and a base station with a set of transmission quality parameters, wherein the transmission quality parameters for each data packet are defined using information included within the data packets, wherein the data packets are transmitted between the server and the base station, according to the assigned set of transmission quality parameters.

(58) In accordance with a further aspect, there is provided a telecommunications system comprising one or more base stations; and data processing apparatus comprising means for carrying out the steps of the any of the above-described methods.

(59) The telecommunications system may include one or more UEs (preferably many UEs of different types), one or more base stations (gNB), one or more service providers, and/or one or more user plane functions (UPF) and any one or more of these nodes or components may be configured to execute any or all of the described methods.

(60) The methods described above may be implemented as a computer program comprising program instructions to operate a computer. The computer program may be stored on a computer-readable medium.

(61) The computer system and telecommunications system may include a processor or processors (e.g. local, virtual or cloud-based) such as a Central Processing unit (CPU), and/or a single or a collection of Graphics Processing Units (GPUs). The processor may execute logic in the form of a software program. The computer system may include a memory including volatile and non-volatile storage medium. A computer-readable medium may be included to store the logic or program instructions. The different parts of the system may be connected using a network (e.g. wireless networks and wired networks). The computer system may include one or more interfaces. The

computer system may contain a suitable operating system such as UNIX, Windows® or Linux, for example. Particular instructions or method steps may be carried out by different components, or the steps may be shared across separate components. Any of the aspects may be combined or different parts of the different described methods may be used with any other described method or parts of the described methods. Furthermore, a telecommunications system may use any one or more (or all) of the described methods. When used together, the separate methods combine to provide additional efficiency gains. For example, either or both of the uplink and the downlink may be enhanced using the described methods.

(62) It should be noted that any feature described above may be used with any particular aspect or embodiment of the invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

- (1) The present invention may be put into practice in a number of ways and embodiments will now be described by way of example only and with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 shows a schematic diagram of an existing system, including User Equipment (UE), a base station and a User Plane Function (UPF);
- (3) FIG. 2 shows a schematic diagram of an existing method for setting up a data radio bearer (DRB) in the system of FIG. 1;
- (4) FIG. 3 shows a schematic diagram of a further existing method for setting up a DRB in the system of FIG. 1;
- (5) FIG. 4 shows a schematic diagram of a further existing method for setting up a DRB in the system of FIG. 1;
- (6) FIG. 5 shows a schematic diagram of an enhanced method for setting up a DRB in a telecommunications system;
- (7) FIG. 6 shows a flowchart of a method for improving the transmission of data;
- (8) FIG. 7 shows a flowchart of a further method for improving the transmission of data;
- (9) FIG. 8 shows a flowchart of a further method for improving the transmission of data;
- (10) FIG. 9 shows a schematic diagram of the timing of messages with a UE in a telecommunications system;
- (11) FIG. 10 shows a schematic diagram of the timing of messages with a UE in a telecommunications system;
- (12) FIG. 11 shows an example information element used to configure a telecommunications system;
- (13) FIG. 12 shows an example information data header used to configure a telecommunications system;
- (14) FIG. 13, shows a schematic diagram of data packets being transmitted within an enhanced telecommunications system; and
- (15) FIG. 14 shows an example set of parameters used to initiate a DRB within the enhanced telecommunications system.
- (16) It should be noted that the figures are illustrated for simplicity and are not necessarily drawn to scale. Like features are provided with the same reference numerals.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

- (17) Mobile network types (e.g., LTE) map different services (e.g., video, voice, web, etc) to particular quality characteristics, which must be satisfied in order to provide a necessary user experience. These services are provided to customers via user equipment (UE) such as smartphones, tablets, IoT devices or other connected devices. Once data packets are sent from the User Plane Function or Entity (UPF) 30 to a base station (or gNB), they are treated according to

pre-defined Quality of Service (QoS) flows that are mapped to a data radio bearer (DRB) **40**. The configuration (features and settings) of the DRBs **40** are selected to fulfil these QoS parameters.

(18) Some data services can be technically realised such that all data packets providing that service are the same or similar in terms of size, periodicity, and other requirements. However, there are some services that have data packets of different size, periodicity, and importance to the customer or end user. One or more data flows may be transmitted as parts of different data services. Furthermore, different data streams within a single data service, can include data packets that are more important than others and so have different technical and quality of transmission requirements.

(19) For example, streaming video into glasses or 3-D goggles may include images of primary importance (visual information provided at the user's central field of view and other images may provide background or peripheral information. These data may be transmitted as separate streams having different compression and other quality parameters. These may comprise I and P frames, for example, providing information for the central and less important peripheral information, respectively.

(20) When a service is setup or initiated, corresponding configurations may be provided to subsequent nodes in the network so that the traffic may be handled according to these configurations and requirements.

(21) In general, different QoS flows may be mapped to separate DRBs **40** to enable the gNB **20** to satisfy the QoS requirements of the air interface. The gNB **20** may enable radio related features and schedule the packets differently for each DRB **40**.

(22) Example characteristics of different QoSs (5GQIs) in 5G are standardized in 23.501 table 5.7.4-1. This is shown in table 1 below.

(23) TABLE-US-00001

Example Type	Priority	Delay	Error	Maximum	Averaging	Services Level	Budget	Rate	Data Burst	Window Volume
TABLE 1	5QI	Value	Resource	Default	Packet	Packet	Default	Default		

(24) Important quality attributes may include: resource type: guaranteed bit rate or non-guaranteed bit rate, priority, packet delay budget, and packet error rates, for example. Other quality attributes may be used. Once the DRB **40** and/or QoS flow or flows **50** are established then these parameters remain known to the gNB **20** without the need for additional data to be sent. Some parameters may be sent to the gNB **20** explicitly. These may include: maximum bit rate, guaranteed bit rate, and allocation retention priority, for example.

(25) In 5G (New Radio-NR) technology, traffic from QoS flows **50** with very similar of the same QoS characteristics may be associated to the same DRB **40** as long the QoS of these QoS flows **50** is satisfied. However, this can lead to higher than necessary resources being provided to data packets from different QoS flows and this can cause inefficiencies in the use of radio and other resources.

(26) The treatment of data packets inside one DRB **40** remains the same for all data packets in that DRB **40**. Whilst this can be acceptable where few different services are being provided to a UE **10**, this can increase inefficiencies when additional data services are added or used at the same time.

(27) FIG. 2 shows schematically a system **100** in which a conventional DRB **40** is set up for a single data service **120** (e.g., a video stream) provided by a server **110**. As can be seen from FIG. 2, all data packets in the uplink (UL) and downlink (DL) on the radio interface within DRB1 are treated the same. In this example, the periodicity of the data streams within DRB1 is 10 ms (other values may be used). This is despite different data packets (or data packet types) having a different value from the perspective of service satisfaction. For example, it may be acceptable for some of the data packets (or frames) to be lost at a higher rate or transmitted with a higher jitter without contributing to unacceptable service degradation. Some data packets may be compressed using different or higher compression ratios or technology and still provide an acceptable user experience. Nevertheless, all data packets within DRB1 are treated the same and expend the same

system and telecommunications resources (e.g., per bit of data).

(28) In the example of FIG. 2, the data service **120** originates within server **110** (e.g., an extended reality server). The data packets are sent to the UPF **30**. The data stream between the UPF **30** and the gNB **20** has a particular set of transmission quality parameters (e.g., each corresponding to the parameter types of table 1). These transmission quality parameters are used to set up a QoS flow (QoS1 in FIG. 2) within which to provide the data packets between the UPF **30** and the gNB **20**.

(29) An application **130** on the UE **10** receives and processes the data packets so that the service can be rendered on the UE **10** or provide an additional service.

(30) Whilst FIGS. 2 illustrates the provision of a data service that has a single type of data packets, some data services can include different types of data packets or frames. FIG. 3 shows schematically a system **200** that expands upon the system **100** of FIG. 2, where a data service **120** includes two different data packet types. For example, an XR data service may include a video stream to provide the XR environment. Other types of data packets may have more demanding requirements such as a live video stream within the XR environment. For example, P-frame data packets and I-frame data packets, used to compress video for both the XR environment and for the live video stream are shown as being sent through the same QoS flow, QoS1 and DRB (DRB1) in FIG. 2.

(31) In order to avoid such a situation where different priority data streams have to be sent with the same transmission quality parameters, then multiple QoS streams and DRBs **40** may be set up. This is illustrated schematically in FIG. 4. In this alternative system **300**, the XR environments stream **120** (having its compressed video data packets) is provided by the server **110** separately to the live video stream **310**. However in this case, the live video stream has its own separate QoS flow (QoS2) with different transmission quality parameters to those of QoS1, which may have lower transmission quality parameter requirements. Separate DRBs (DRB1 and DRB2) are also set up between the gNB **20** and the UE **10** to provide these separate data streams. As can be seen from FIG. 4, one DRB has a periodicity of 10 ms (DRB2), whilst DRB1 has a periodicity of 100 ms. This is to accommodate the different data streams, which have different requirements. Whilst this avoids sending data packets at higher transmission quality parameters than necessary, this requires the setting up of an additional DRB, which has its own system overhead and is itself a limited resource.

(32) Whilst the number of DRBs that any one UE **10** can support in New Radio (5G) has increased from eight DRBs to 32 DRBs, this still represents a limited resource. FIG. 5 illustrates the system mapping the two different QoS flows (QoS1 and QoS2) to the same DRB (DRB1) set up with the highest speed periodicity (10 ms) of the two DRBs of FIG. 4 but again, this configuration sends some data packets using a higher set of transmission quality parameters than necessary for that particular data stream.

(33) There are several separate but complementary ways in which this situation can be improved. Each individual method that will be described can be used on its own and improve overall efficiency and effectiveness of the telecommunications system or they may be combined in any combination for even greater effect and improvement.

(34) FIG. 6 shows a flow chart of a method **600** for communicating data to a UE **10**. The data are transmitted in the form of data packets and may originate from a server **110**, service or other network function. At step **610**, a DRB **40** is established between a base station or gNB **20** and a UE **10**. At step **620**, the data packets are transmitted between the base station **20** and the UE **10** over the DRB **40** using different transmission quality parameters. Therefore, data traffic can be more efficiently communicated with the UE **10**. For example, a video stream may include different parts or frames having different characteristics and requirements related to reliability, packet delay budget and acceptable jitter. These can be sent over the same DRB **40** and so reducing the total number of necessary DRBs but without having to set up the DRB **40** with the highest transmission quality parameter for any particular data packet type. This reduces the overall required overheads

of the system and so more data can be transmitted more efficiently. Therefore, the DRB **40** can operate with variable transmission properties rather than being fixed.

(35) FIG. **7** shows a flowchart of a further method **700** for improving the communication of data to the UE **10**. Again, a DRB **40** is established between the base station or gNB **20** and the UE **10** at step **710**. The data packets are transmitted over the DRB **40** at different or variable periodicities. For example, the base station **20** may provide the UE **10** with information mapping the periodicities of the different data packets or data packet types in a time division multiplexed data stream. The information mapping the periodicities of the separate data services in the multiplexed data stream may be provided as a table to the UE **10** or in another format.

(36) Whilst methods **600** and **700** described with reference to FIGS. **6** and **7**, respectively, improve the use of resources used for the DRB **40**, further improvements may be achieved when communicating the data packets between the service provision server **110** providing the data service and the base station **20**. Such a method **800** is shown as a flowchart in FIG. **8**.

(37) At step **810**, each data packet is assigned with a set of transmission quality parameters. The base station **20** or the UPF (a server) **30** or another part of the core network may carry out this assignment or this may be determined in another way. The assignment of transmission quality parameters may be explicit. For example, this may be achieved by providing a set of transmission quality parameters with each data packet, e.g., as part of a header, or defining a predetermined set of parameters out of a plurality of sets of parameters. Alternatively, the data packets may be assigned with or as a data packet type, where each type has an associated set of transmission quality parameters. The information may be examined before a new QoS flow is established and set it up with more appropriate transmission quality parameters. Therefore, the QoS flow can be established and its resources allocated more appropriately according to uplink requirements from the UE **10** (e.g., for live video streaming).

(38) The information defining the transmission quality parameters are included within the data packets. This information may also be implicit and indicated by the nature or properties of the data packets (e.g., size, content, etc.) In an example implementation, the information is included within a part of a GTP-U header of the data packet. At step **830** the data packets are transmitted between the server (e.g., UPF **30** that receives the data from server **110**) and the base station **20**.

(39) The following describes the implementation of these methods and systems in more detail.

(40) In current telecommunication systems, UEs **10** are not necessarily listening to data channels all of the time but only during certain periods. This is illustrated schematically in FIG. **9**. This figure illustrates at a high level how the UE **10** wakes up during a drx-on-duration timer and go to sleep after this time. When the UE **10** is scheduled with data during the time that it was active, then it would stay awake for an additional period (drx-inactive).

(41) FIG. **10** illustrates schematically the process of the UE **10** sending data. As can be seen in FIG. **10**, the timer drx-HARQ-RTT-TimerUL defines the period that the UE **10** can expect a grant for uplink re-transmission. A further timer, drx-RetransmissionTimerUL, specifies a maximum number of slots for which the UE **10** should be monitoring PDCCH when a grant for uplink re-transmission is expected by the UE **10**. Therefore, the gNB is able to send different parameters per stream to the UE **10**. For example, the UE **10** may wait for retransmissions from the gNB **20** for a greater time for one data stream than for another.

(42) Depending on the particular traffic characteristics, the DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL might be configured with different values or time periods and this needs to be provided to the UE **10**. There may be multiple DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL values that are provided to the UE **10**. In some examples, DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL_low and DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL_high may need to be defined to differentiate between low and high priority packets, which also require acknowledgment. For example, DRX configuration inside a RRCReconfiguration message may be used or any other RRC message where DRX-Configuration is present. An example current DRX-Configuration is shown in FIG. **11** (taken from 3GPP TS 38.331 V17.0.0 (2022-03)).

(43) Providing information to the gNB **20** regarding a transmission quality parameter such as the priority of a data packet (e.g., high or low priority), is important as this enables the dNB **20** to be able to differentiate between DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL_Low and DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL_high data packets. Furthermore, this allows the gNB **20** to know how long the UE **20** will be waiting to receive an “ack” message. It is one enhancement to the current system that the UE **10** provides this information to the gNB **20**.

(44) In one example implementation of this enhancement, the MAC-PDU header, which normally consists of several sub-headers, may be used. As it can be seen from the table 2, which shows the structure and values of LCID for UL-SCH, there is a reserved bit in the MAC header. According to this enhancement, this reserved bit may be used to indicate the importance of the data packet or other transmission quality parameter or set of parameters. Therefore, the UE **10** is able to differentiate streams with different characteristics and able to send packets to the gNB **20** identifying different streams using the MAC header.

(45) If finer grained information about the importance of data packets is required, i.e. a need to provide more information than low and high importance data packets, then this also requires more than two different DRX retransmissionTimerUL timers. This requires more than one bit to indicate the priority of the packet or other transmission quality parameter. Therefore, in another example implementation of this enhancement, other reserved bits may be used, for example, the reserved bits from LCID (or eLCID), as illustrated schematically in FIG. **12**.

(46) Table 6.2 1-2 Values of LCID for UL-SCH

(47) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Codepoint/ Index LCID values 0 CCCH of size 64 bits (referred to as “CCCH1” in TS 38.331 [5]), except for a RedCap UE 1-32 Identity of the logical channel of DCCH and DTCH 33 Extended logical channel ID field (two-octet eLCID field) 34 Extended logical channel ID field (one-octet eLCID field) 35 CCCH of size 48 bits (referred to as “CCCH” in TS 38.331 [5]) for a RedCap UE 36 CCCH1 of size 64 bits (referred to as “CCCH1” in TS 38.331 [5]) for a RedCap UE 37-43 Reserved 44 Timing Advance Report 45 Truncated Sidelink BSR 46 Sidelink BSR 47 Reserved 48 LBT failure (four octets) 49 LBT failure (one octets) 50 BFR (one octet C.sub.i) 51 Truncated BFR (one octet C.sub.i) 52 CCCH of size 48 bits (referred to as “CCCH” in TS 38.331 [5]), except for a RedCap UE 53 Recommended bit rate query 54 Multiple Entry PHR (four octet C.sub.i) 55 Configured Grant Confirmation 56 Multiple Entry PHR (one octet C.sub.i) 57 Single entry PHR 58 C-RNTI 59 Short Truncated BSR 60 Long Truncated BSR 61 Short BSR 62 Long BSR 63 Padding

(48) The DRX-RetransmissionTimerUL is not the only parameter which that has been enhanced. A different number of retransmissions can be indicated and used for different priority data packets. This number of retransmissions may also depend on the required reliability for a given data stream inside one DRB **40**. Therefore, data packets that are more important may use a higher number of repetitions (i.e., another transmission quality parameter) compared with other, lower priority data packets or streams. These show example transmission quality parameters and how they may be communicated to different components within the system.

(49) These are examples of a method for use within a wireless digital telecommunication system including a base station and a terminal or UE **10**, wherein the base station **20** provides the UE **10** with a set of parameters to be used within the same data radio bearer depending on the priority of the packets and wherein the priority of the packets is indicated to the gNB **20**.

(50) Physical Uplink Shared Channel (PUSCH) Resources are transmitted with particular periodicities in telecommunications systems (e.g., 5G). The following enhancement describes how these periodicities can be varied within different components and how this information can be received when the periodicities are varied. This involves the use of a table or bitmap of the periodicity, which is communicated between components or nodes in the system.

(51) The bitmap of periodicities is provided to the UE **10** for combined use of Uplink resources. This enables a further enhancement by enabling the scheduling of the UE **10** to be carried out in a

more optimised way. This improves efficiencies as different data packets can be treated differently rather than transmitting them according to the highest requirements through a DRB **40**. This can be especially useful if the data packets have different round trip timing (RTT) requirements, for example.

(52) A table or bitmap with this periodicity mapping is provided to the UE or UEs **10**. In the example illustrated in tables 3 to 5, there are two different data services with different periodicity requirements. As described previously, the two separate data services can set up two separate DRBs (DRB1 and DRB2 set up according to the separate requirements of table 3) having different transmission quality parameters (in this example, 100 ms and 150 ms periodicities), in a similar way to that shown in FIG. **4**.

(53) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 DRB1 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms DRB2 150 ms 150 ms 150 ms 150 ms

(54) Alternatively, the data packets from the two different data services may be multiplexed (e.g., using time division multiplexing) within the same DRB **40**, as in a similar way to that shown in FIG. **5**, i.e., multiplexed into a single DRB **40**. In existing telecommunications networks, this requires a DRB **40** to be set up according to the requirements shown in table 4, i.e., with the lowest latency multiplexing being used for all data packets (100 ms in this example).

(55) TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 DRB1 Stream 1 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms DRB1 Stream 2 150 ms 150 ms 150 ms 150 ms 150 ms Multiplex DRB 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms 100 ms

(56) However, when a mapping of the periodicities of the different data packet types can be sent to the UE **10** then variable periodicities can be used, specific to each data packet or data packet type.

(57) TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 5 Stream 1 100 ms/X 100 ms/X 100 ms/X 100 ms/X 100 ms/X Stream 2 150 ms/Y 150 ms/Y 100 ms/Y 150 ms/Y 150 ms/Y Table of new 100 ms/x + y 100 ms/x 100 ms/x + y 100 ms/x 100 ms/x + y transmission provided to the UE

(58) X and Y are data packets belonging to stream 1 and stream 2, respectively. The gNB **20** provides a “configured grant” configuration with a periodicity that the data may be sent in Uplink (UL) and also a configuration describing the periodicities of each data stream. The UE **10** may then transmit data belonging to Stream 1 or Stream 2 or alternatively, as a bit of one stream and a bit of the other stream. More than two streams may be used in a similar way. Whatever transmission scheme is used, the information used define such a scheme is encoded within a bitmap or schema (e.g., a table such as table 5). Such a table or bitmap may be devised based on properties of the data, available buffers and/or particular QoS requirements. In another example implementation, the separate data streams may relate to the I and P frames of a video stream. I-frames need to be transmitted less frequently than P-frames but require more system resources as they are less compressed. In this example, there is one data service being provided (e.g., live stream video) but two (or more types) of data packets are used and transmitted at different periodicities through the same DRB **40**.

(59) Information is provided to the UE **10** so that it can determine which data belongs to which stream. The way in which this information is provided may depend on the data within the stream. However, this information may be provided by using upper layer protocols such as GTP-U, TCP, UDP or others.

(60) The above-described implementations describe enhancements to the UL and downlink (DL), including providing the UE **10** with a visibility of data traffic patterns. Similar and additional improvements are available for the Downlink (DL), requiring the base station (e.g., gNB) **20** to have visibility of the incoming packets. Some of the examples of traffic pattern characteristics include but are not limited to: the periodicity of the data, the amount of data in a particular time interval, packet value, and acceptable jitter.

(61) This may be achieved using new QoS/5QI values and GTP-U packet marking, for example. The Access and Mobility Management Function (AMF) may include new characteristics for use

when a new QoS Flow is established. These new characteristics may include but are not limited to: the periodicity of the data stream, the size of the data packet, relative importance of the data traffic, etc. This is illustrated schematically as the packet flow shown in FIG. 13. This figure illustrates data packets being sent having different sizes and with different priorities, through the DRB 40. New attributes may be included as new QoS values or as separate priorities. This is illustrated schematically in FIG. 14.

(62) FIG. 14 illustrates an example of inclusion of new traffic characteristics and indication of new characteristics using newly a defined QoS Class Index (QCI). QCI indicates QoS attributes of the traffic including the legacy QoS attributes (BLER and priority) and the newly added QoS attributes of traffic arrival pattern. The traffic arrival pattern in this example is that the first packet arrives at T1 and the second packet arrives at T1+100 ms, the third packet arrives at T1+100+50 ms and the fourth packet arrives at T1+100+50+50 ms. The packet arrival pattern repeats. As such the fifth packet arrives at T1+100+50+50+100 ms and so on. The corresponding QCI value is communicated to the network nodes at the bearer setup, e.g., using information included within the data packets. This information may be included as GTP-U packet marking, for example. Different combinations of packet arrival patterns and different repeating lengths and timings may be used. Moreover, bearers can be setup using the legacy bearer setup procedure, e.g., using control plane signalling for bearer setup.

(63) FIG. 14 also illustrates the newly added QoS attributes of traffic arrival as a separately added QoS attribute. QCI values refers to the legacy QoS attributes such as BLER and priority, while the traffic arrival pattern is provided together with the QCI value. In this example traffic arrival pattern is provided as an array [100 ms, 50 ms, 50 ms]. This has the same interpretation as above such that the first packet arrives at T1 and the second packet arrives at T1+100 ms, the third packet arrives at T1+100+50 ms and the fourth packet arrives at T1+100+50+50 ms. The packet arrival pattern repeats. As such the fifth packet arrives at T1+100+50+50+100 ms and so on. the corresponding QCI value and the traffic arrival pattern is communicated to the corresponding network nodes at the bearer setup.

(64) The base station (e.g., gNB) 20 receives such parameters and sets up DRB(s) 40 accordingly. User Plane data packets may be recognised at the gNB level in DL based on any information inside the headers of transport protocols (e.g., GTP-U, UDP, TCP, RTP, etc.).

(65) As will be appreciated by the skilled person, details of the above embodiment may be varied without departing from the scope of the present invention, as defined by the appended claims.

(66) For example, the example systems are shown as having a single UE but many UEs may be included and serviced by the described systems and methods. Furthermore, a plurality of base stations (e.g., gNBs) may be added to the system and include the described enhanced functionality. Various components within the systems may implement the described methods, including the UEs, the base stations, the servers and/or dedicated servers (e.g., virtual, dynamic, or static servers). Other multiplexing types may be used and this is not limited to time division multiplexing

(67) Many combinations, modifications, or alterations to the features of the above embodiments will be readily apparent to the skilled person and are intended to form part of the invention. Any of the features described specifically relating to one embodiment or example may be used in any other embodiment by making the appropriate changes.

Claims

1. A method for communicating data with user equipment, UE, the method comprising the steps of: establishing a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE; and transmitting data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted by multiplexing data packets for different data packet types at different periodicities in a time division multiplexed data stream, and wherein the DRB provides means to handle data

packet types having different periodicities.

2. The method of claim 1, further comprising the step of the base station providing the UE with information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types in the time division multiplexed data stream.

3. The method of claim 2, wherein the information mapping the periodicities of the separate data services in the multiplexed data stream are provided as a table.

4. The method of claim 2, wherein the information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types is provided to the UE within radio resource control, RRC, protocol during configuration of the DRB.

5. The method of claim 4, wherein the information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types is provided to the UE within radio resource control, RRC, protocol during configuration of the DRB within configured grant configuration.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the data packets between the base station and the UE are uplink data packets.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein the uplink data packets are transmitted on a physical uplink shared channel, PUSCH.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein separate data services have different round trip timing, RTT requirements.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein separate data services have different periodicity requirements.

10. The method of claim 1, wherein the different data packet types include I and P frames.

11. A telecommunications system comprising: one or more base stations; and a User Equipment, UE, comprising: a processor; and non-transitory computer readable storage medium having stored thereon executable instructions that when executed by the processor cause the UE to perform the following: establish a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE; and transmit data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted by multiplexing data packets for different data packet types at different periodicities in a time division multiplexed data stream, and wherein the DRB provides means to handle data packet types having different periodicities.

12. A User Equipment, UE, comprising: a processor; and non-transitory computer readable storage medium having stored thereon executable instructions that when executed by the processor cause the UE to perform the following: establish a data radio bearer, DRB, between a base station and the UE; and transmit data packets between the base station and the UE through the DRB, wherein data packets are transmitted by multiplexing data packets for different data packet types at different periodicities in a time division multiplexed data stream, and wherein the DRB provides means to handle data packet types having different periodicities.

13. The UE of claim 1, the UE is provided from a base station information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types in the time division multiplexed data stream.

14. The UE of claim 13, wherein the information mapping the periodicities of the separate data services in the multiplexed data stream are provided as a table.

15. The UE of claim 13, wherein the information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types is provided to the UE within radio resource control, RRC, protocol during configuration of the DRB.

16. The UE of claim 15, wherein the information mapping the periodicities of the different data packet types is provided to the UE within radio resource control, RRC, protocol during configuration of the DRB within configured grant configuration.

17. The UE of claim 12, wherein the data packets between the base station and the UE are uplink data packets.

18. The UE of claim 17, wherein the uplink data packets are transmitted on a physical uplink shared channel, PUSCH.

19. The UE of claim 12, wherein separate data services have different round trip timing, RTT

requirements.

20. The UE of claim 12, wherein separate data services have different periodicity requirements.
